

Seven Add-ons That Help Thunderbird Mimic MS Outlook

In the last issue, we discussed configuring Mozilla Thunderbird using DavMail to access MS Exchange Server the open source way. Still, a lot of limitations make us avoid the 'bird. So, in this article, I highlight seven useful add-ons that help Thunderbird mimic MS Outlook behaviour on Linux or Windows.



1. SmartTemplate

This add-on allows you to customise the default quote header by using templates. These can be created for every account as well as globally (for all accounts). It can be downloaded at <http://bit.ly/Xm4nre> while its website, <http://smarttemplate4.mozdev.org/> lists its features, which are given below:

- Custom templates can be defined and automatically used to compose, reply to and forward messages (you can have a separate template for each).
- Supports HTML and plain-text.
- You can add your signature to your mail template (from Thunderbird's account settings).
- Mail templates can be for a single account or common to all accounts.
- Intelligent content in your template by use of keywords (variables).
- This add-on does not change the default config settings (e.g., `mailnews.reply_header_xxx`). This means that global settings and other add-ons are not affected by its installation.
- Template code in HTML lets you prepare various templates to suit your corporate style. The sample below is the style I personally use at work—almost the same style as Outlook.

If you're good at HTML, you can follow the add-on syntax and hack away; if you're not, do not worry, you can easily use the templates available on its website.

```
<div style="font-family: Calibri, Arial, sans-serif; font-size: 10.5pt;color: #000000; ">
<hr/>
<b>From:</b> %ffrom(name)% <%ffrom(mail)%><br>
<b>Sent:</b> %X:=-sent%&A%, %d%.%h%.%M% %p% %&S:=%M% %data_t%<br>
<b>To:</b> %to(name)% <%to(mail)%>
[[<hr><b>Cc:</b> %cc(name)% <%cc(mail)%>]]<hr>
<b>Subject:</b> %subject%
</div>
```



Note: One of the reviews for this add-on says, "This is simply the best extension if you want to continue to use Linux at the office. Most businesses seem to have custom email stationery set up in Outlook, and Thunderbird just isn't well equipped for it when run through Linux. SmartTemplate4 means that I can 'use' Calibri and other fonts when sending emails out, so that I am in line with the company's email style guide."